

More moves

Cleveland's busy offseason continues, as defensive lineman Robaire Smith agrees to deal, and fullback Terrelle Smith is released. **Page C3**



SPORTS

WWW.CHRONICLET.COM

More Sports:  
**Indians**  
Page D1

Section  
**C**  
Thursday,  
March 15,  
2007

Ohio State center Greg Oden directs a play Wednesday during practice at Rupp Arena in Lexington, Ky. Oden just as easily could've been showing 16th-seeded Central Connecticut State the way back home.



NCAA TOURNAMENT: OHIO STATE

Goliath ready for best shot

No. 1 OSU vows not to take Devils lightly

**Shaun Bennett**  
The Chronicle-Telegram  
LEXINGTON, Ky. — A smile crept across Greg Oden's face. He then put his massive hand over his mouth in an attempt to conceal the ensuing laughter. The 7-foot Ohio State freshman center had just been told the story about how Central Connecticut State President Dr. John W. Miller handed each Blue Devil player a small stone before they traveled to Rupp Arena for the first-round show-

down with the top-seeded and top-ranked Buckeyes. The gift was to symbolize the classic biblical battle between David and Goliath, where the diminutive David slew the mighty Goliath with a small rock and a sling. "They can't use those, can they?" Oden asked. "I hope that's illegal." Central Connecticut State will have to settle for slinging long-range shots during today's South regional opener against

Ohio State. The No. 16-seeded Blue Devils set a school record with 252 3-pointers this season, led by junior guard Tristan Blackwood — who set a Northeast Conference record with 118. "You have to worry about that because they could win the game shooting all those threes," Oden said. "We just have to go out there and play good perimeter defense." While Oden was chuckling in the locker room, Buckeyes See **OSU, C5**

TONIGHT

**WHO:** Ohio State vs. Central Connecticut State  
**TIME:** 7:10  
**WHERE:** Rupp Arena, Lexington, Ky.  
**TV/RADIO:** Ch. 19; WKNR 850-AM, WEOL 930-AM (joined in progress)  
**INSIDE:** OSU notes and the game's top matchup. **C5**

**ON TV: WOIO, CHANNEL 19**  
● Boston College vs. Texas Tech, 12:25 p.m.  
● Butler vs. Old Dominion, 2:40  
● BYU vs. Xavier, 9:30

CAVALIERS 118, GRIZZLIES 96

James back, leads romp

The Associated Press  
MEMPHIS, Tenn. — The Memphis Grizzlies wish LeBron James' back had bothered the Cleveland Cavaliers star another night. James recovered from his injury to score 29 points, leading seven Cleveland players in double figures and helping the Cavaliers beat the Grizzlies 118-96 Wednesday night for their season-high seventh straight victory. James, who sat out Cleveland's 124-100 victory over Sacramento on Tuesday night with back spasms, connected on 11 of 17 shots from the field. James hit his first five shots of the third quarter, helping Cleveland build the lead to 33. The Cavs starters did not return in the final period. "I was just in a zone," James said. "I felt like I couldn't miss, and I dropped a lot of jumpers and bumped the lead up. That gave us an opportunity to sit on the bench for the fourth." Memphis, with the league's worst record, lost its second straight and eighth in the past nine. Zydrunas Ilgauskas scored 18 points for Cleveland, while Larry Hughes had 13 points and six assists. Donyell Marshall had 12, Sasha Pavlovic scored 11, and Drew Gooden and Anderson Varejao had 10 apiece. "Right now, we can't relax because we have to look at the big picture," Ilgauskas said. "But right now, we are satisfied with the way we played these last few games."

See **CAVS, C4**

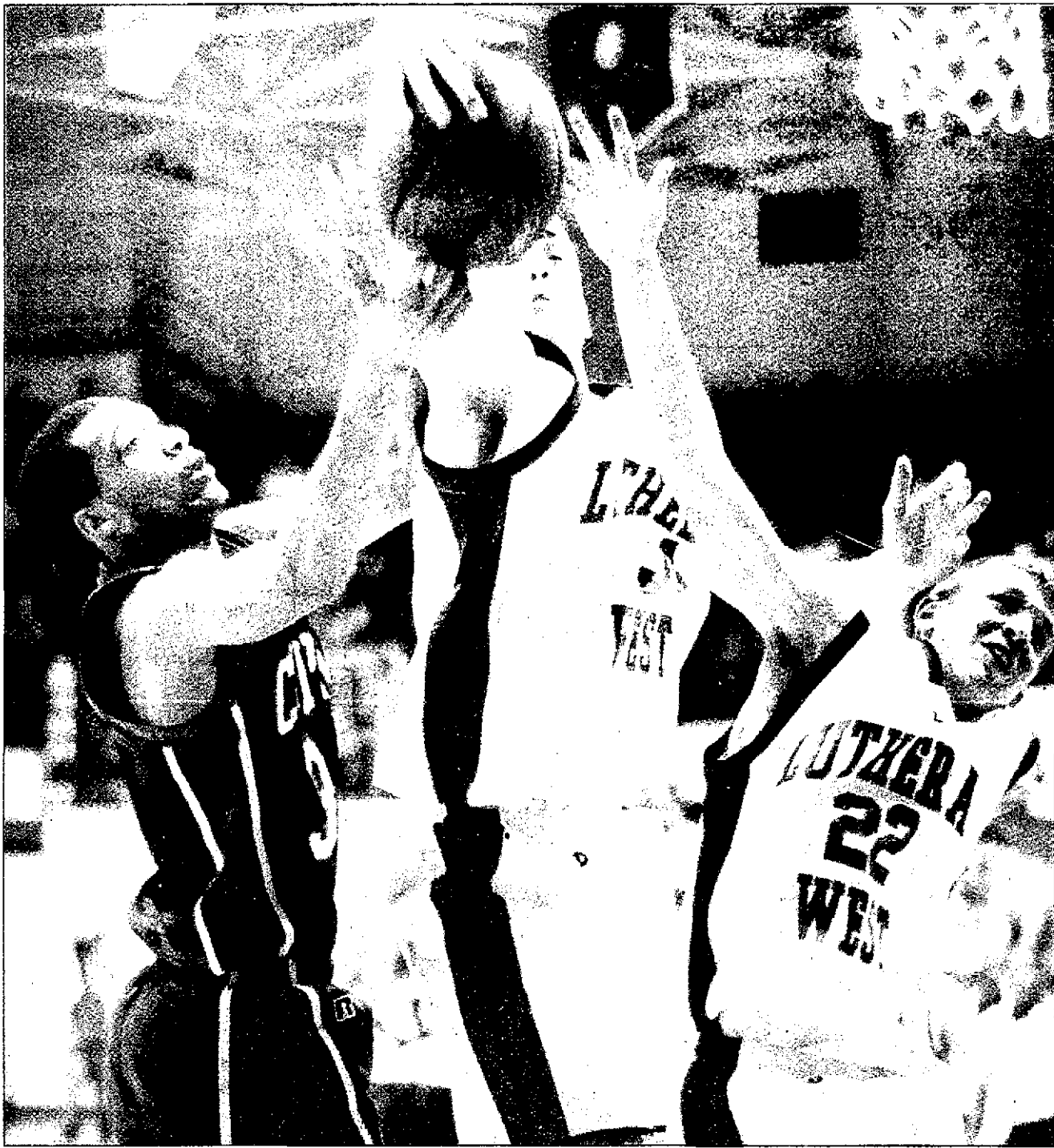


NEXT UP

**WHO:** Cleveland vs. Utah  
**WHEN:** Saturday, 7:30 p.m.  
**WHERE:** Quicken Loans Arena  
**TV/RADIO:** FSN Ohio; WTAM 1100-AM

THE TOURNAMENT TRAIL: BOYS REGIONAL BASKETBALL

'Horns get hot, move on



Lutheran West Mike Telzrow (center) grabs a rebound from Campbell's Anthony Moses and teammate Andrew Thomas.

Late run, Voiers lift Longhorns

**Bob Daniels**  
The Chronicle-Telegram  
CANTON — Nothing like a good 18-0 run to pull your fat from the fire. Lutheran West's Longhorns, who had a hot hand anyhow, went on a huge fourth-quarter tear Wednesday night just when they needed it most. They trailed Campbell Memorial by three points when they put it together with about six minutes left in their Division III regional semifinal. It launched them to a 67-56 victory in front of a loud and animated crowd in the Canton Fieldhouse. With it, the Longhorns (22-1) earned a 7:30 p.m. Saturday date with Villa Angela-St. Joseph for the regional title and a berth in the Final Four next week. VASJ rolled over Manchester 63-43 in Wednesday night's opener. Hot hand? Lutheran West drilled 27 of 45 field goal attempts, an eye-opening 60 percent. They drilled 8-of-10 from outside the 3-point arc, and were 5-of-8 from the foul line. Hot hand? How about junior Scott Voiers, who drained the first three 3-pointers he attempted — all in the first three minutes of the game. He added two more in the second half on his way to a game-high 30 points. And he scored 10 of the 18 points in the Longhorns' big fourth-quarter run. Andrew See **HORNS, C2**

TONIGHT

**WHO:** Olmsted Falls (21-2) vs. Kenmore (16-6)  
**STATE RANK:** Olmsted Falls, 8th; Kenmore, not ranked  
**WHAT:** Division II regional semifinal  
**TIME:** 7 o'clock  
**WHERE:** Canton Fieldhouse  
**RADIO:** WEOL 930-AM

**Steve Byrne**  
The Chronicle-Telegram

It would sound simplistic to say tonight's regional semifinal between Kenmore and Olmsted Falls will be a battle of size against speed. Neither Pat Donahue nor Dan Freeman, however, would disagree with that assessment. "They're gigantic," said Don-

ahue, the Olmsted Falls head coach. "They're not toothpick 6-8 kids, either. They have big bodies and they're beasts on the rebounding. We're going to have a tough time keeping them off the boards." St. Vincent-St. Mary sure had trouble doing it. Kenmore grabbed 58 rebounds in its 54-52 double-overtime victory over the favored Irish. Joe Miller, who

leads the Cardinals with a rebounding average of 12 per game, took down 18 against SVSM, one rebound short of a district-tournament record. Kenmore's victory over SVSM ended that school's run of nine consecutive district titles. Donahue said the outcome was not that big of a surprise to him. "I don't know if it was that big of an upset," he said. "Kenmore

went into the season as one of the favorites to win the Akron City Series. They have a real good point guard and they're big. I saw them against Buchtel (district semifinal), so it wasn't a surprise to me." Buchtel had beaten Kenmore twice in the regular season before the Cardinals pinned a 20-point loss on the Griffins in the tournament. See **FALLS, C3**

Nice selection! Cars, SUV's, Mini-vans

**FREE! 1 YEAR/12,000 MILE WARRANTY\***  
On All Used Cars This Week Only

All Used Cars Inspected, Certified, Good To Go!

**J.D. BYRIDER**

Up to \$500 Grocery Savings Coupon Book  
\$1000 Minimum Trade-In Allowance  
with Vehicle Purchase

We'll work with you on a payment plan

AT 58 HAMHERST  
440-988-3000  
2 Miles South of I-90

'00 Chevy Z24  
'03 Dodge Stratus, V6  
'00 Ford Ranger XLT  
'00 Ford Ranger XLT  
'02 Chrysler PT Cruiser  
'97 Dodge Dakota SLT, V6  
'03 Dodge Stratus

VALUABLE COUPON  
\$1000 off  
any Vehicle  
In Stock

\*Limited Warranty. See dealer for our extended service contracts. Dealer's price. Participating dealer for details. Dealer's price. Your interest and payments may vary.